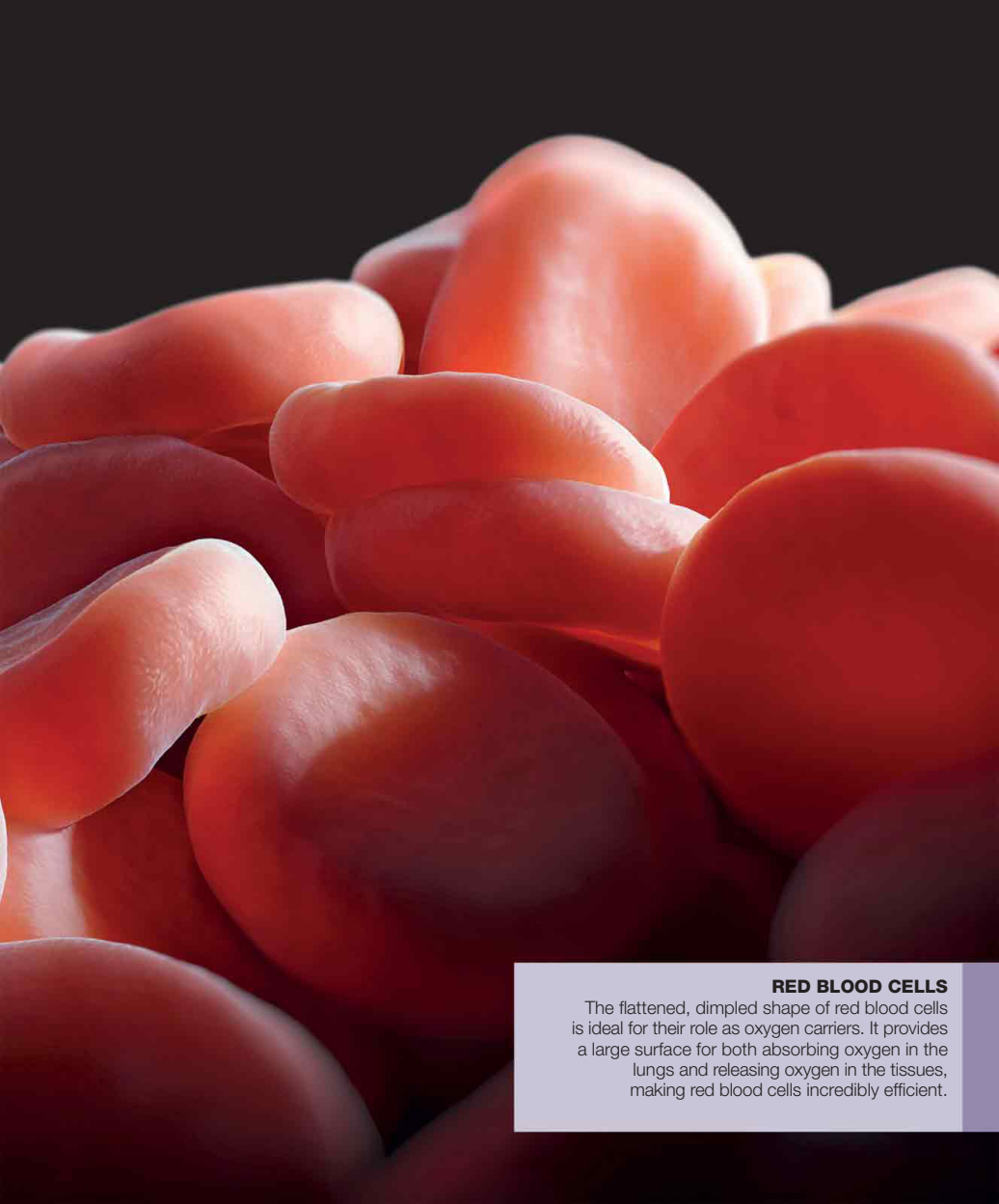




RED BLOOD CELLS

The flattened, dimpled shape of red blood cells is ideal for their role as oxygen carriers. It provides a large surface for both absorbing oxygen in the lungs and releasing oxygen in the tissues, making red blood cells incredibly efficient.